

5 ft (1.5m) or more. Has thick stems that bear broad, floppy, blue-green leaves. Produces dense, erect panicles of whitish-yellow spikelets in summer. Can be grown in moist soil. Z6–9. **var. versicolor** (syn. *A.d.* ‘Variegata’) illus. p.436. **‘Variegata’** see *A.d.* var. *versicolor*.

ASARINA

PLANTAGINACEAE

Genus of one species of trailing, evergreen perennial, grown for its flowers. Hardy to 14°F (–10°C), but herbaceous in cold regions. Grow in a site with full light in any well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring.

A. barclayana. See *Maurandya barclayana*.

A. erubescens. See *Lophospermum erubescens*.

A. procumbens, syn. *Antirrhinum asarina*, illus. p.371.

ASARUM

SYN. HEXASTYLIS
Wild ginger

ARISTOLOCHACEAE

Genus of rhizomatous perennials, mainly evergreen, with pitcher-shaped flowers under kidney- or heart-shaped leaves. Good for groundcover, although leaves may become damaged in severe weather. Prefers shade and humus-rich, moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by division in spring. Self seeds readily.

A. caudatum. Evergreen, prostrate, rhizomatous perennial. H 6in (15cm), S 12in (30cm) or more. Heart-shaped, leathery, glossy, dark green leaves, 2–4in (5–10cm) across, conceal small, pitcher-shaped, reddish-brown or brownish-purple flowers, with tail-like lobes, in early summer. Z7–9 **A. europaeum** (Asarabacca) illus. p.375. **A. hartwegii,** syn. *A. marmoratum*.

Evergreen, prostrate, rhizomatous perennial. H 3in (8cm), S to 12in (30cm) or more. Pitcher-shaped, very dark brown, almost black, flowers, with tail-like lobes, are produced in early summer beneath heart-shaped, silver-marked, mid-green leaves, 2–4in (5–10cm) across. Z2–8

A. marmoratum. See *A. hartwegii*.

A. splendens. Evergreen, prostrate, rhizomatous perennial. H 4in (10cm), S 8in (20cm) or more. Bears solitary, broadly heart-shaped to nearly arrow-shaped, often white-blotched, dull-green leaves, to 4in (10cm) long. In spring, produces bell-shaped, dark purple-green flowers, to 1½in (3cm) long, with broad, ovate lobes, to ¾in (2cm) long. Z5–9

ASCLEPIAS

Silk weed

APOCYNACEAE/ASCLEPIADACEAE

Genus of tuberous perennials and a few subshrubs or shrubs, some of which are evergreen, grown for their flowers. Stems exude milky, white latex when cut. Where marginally hardy, prefers a position in sun and a humus-rich, well-drained soil. Propagate by division or seed in spring. Frost tender species require sun and a moist atmosphere; cut back during periods of growth. Water very sparingly in low temperatures.

Propagate by tip cuttings or seed in spring. ☉Contact with the milky sap may irritate skin.

A. curassavica (Bloodflower). Evergreen, bushy, tuberous subshrub. H 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm). Has narrowly ovate leaves to 6in (15cm) long. Umbels of small, but showy, 5-horned, orange-red flowers with yellow centers are borne in summer–fall and are followed by narrowly ovoid, pointed fruits, 3in (8cm) long, with silky seeds. Z9–11 (min. 45°F/7°C)

A. hallii. Upright, tuberous perennial. H to 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm). Has oblong leaves, to 5in (13cm) long. Umbels of small, 5-horned, dark pink flowers are borne in summer; tightly packed silky seeds are enclosed in narrowly ovoid fruits, to 6in (15cm) long. Z9–11

A. physocarpa. See *Gomphocarpus physocarpus*.

A. syriaca. (Common milkweed) Upright, tuberous perennial. H to 6ft (2m), S indefinite. Has ovate leaves to 8in (20cm) long. Bears umbels of small, 5-horned, purplish-pink flowers on drooping flower stalks in summer, followed by narrowly ovoid fruits, to 6in (15cm) long and filled with silky seeds. Z3–9

A. tuberosa (Butterflyweed) illus. p.246.

ASIMINA

ANNONACEAE

Genus of deciduous or evergreen shrubs and small trees, grown for their foliage and flowers. Needs full sun and fertile, deep, moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in fall or by layering or root cuttings in winter.

A. triloba (Pawpaw). Deciduous, open shrub. H and S 20ft (6m). Large, ovate, mid-green leaves emerge in late spring or early summer, just after, or at the same time as, 6-petaled, purplish-brown flowers. Later it produces small, globular, brownish, edible fruits. Z6–8

ASPARAGUS

ASPARAGACEAE/LILIACEAE

Genus of perennials, climbers and subshrubs, some of which are evergreen, grown for their foliage. Grow in partial shade or bright light, but not direct sun, in any fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or division in spring.

A. densiflorus illus. p.474. **‘Myersii’** (syn. *A. meyeri*, *A.* ‘Myers’; Foxtail fern) illus. p.474.

A. meyeri. See *A. densiflorus* ‘Myersii’.

A. ‘Myers’. See *A. densiflorus* ‘Myersii’.

A. scandens illus. p.463.

ASPERULA

RUBIACEAE

Genus of annuals, perennials and dwarf shrubs; some species are good as alpine houseplants. Most species need sun and well-drained soil with moisture at roots. Dislikes winter wet on crown. Propagate by softwood cuttings or seed in early summer.

A. athoa of gardens. See *A. suberosa*.

A. odorata. See *Galium odoratum*.

A. suberosa, syn. *A. athoa* of gardens, illus. p.362.

ASPHODELINE

ASPHODELACEAE/LILIACEAE

Genus of perennials with thick, fleshy roots, grown for their star-shaped flowers. Requires sun and not over-rich soil. Propagate by division in early spring, taking care not to damage roots, or by seed in fall or spring.

A. liburnica. Clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 12in (30cm). Has needlelike, blue-green leaves, to 10in (25cm) long, borne only on the lower part of the flower stems. Produces slender racemes, 6–9in (15–22cm) long, of pale yellow flowers in summer, 2in (5cm) across, with narrowly ovate to lance-shaped bracts, ½in (1.5cm) long, the petal backs striped green. Z6–9 **A. lutea** (Yellow asphodel) illus. p.227.

ASPHODELUS

ASPHODELACEAE/LILIACEAE

Genus of spring- or summer-flowering annuals and perennials. Requires sun; most prefer fertile, well-drained soil. *A. albus* prefers light, well-drained soil. Propagate by division in spring or by seed in fall.

A. acaulis. Evergreen, stemless rhizomatous perennial. H to 6in (15cm), S 8in (20cm). Has rosettes of flat, linear, light green leaves, to 8in (20cm) long.

In late winter and early spring, produces racemes of open funnel-shaped, pale pink or white, green-veined flowers, to 1½in (4cm) across, with white bracts. Z9–10 **A. albus** (White asphodel) illus. p.230. **A. fistulosus,** syn. *A. tenuifolius*.

Annual or short-lived perennial. H 18in (45cm), S 8in (20cm). Has a dense, basal clump of narrow, cylindrical, keeled, mid-green leaves, to 14in (35cm) long. In mid- and late summer, hollow, often branched stems bear panicles of star-shaped, pinkish white flowers, to 1in (25cm) across, with brown central veins, amid white bracts. Z6–10

A. tenuifolius. See *A. fistulosus*.

ASPIDISTRA

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of evergreen, rhizomatous perennials, grown mainly for their glossy foliage. Very tolerant, but is best grown in a cool, shady position away from direct sunlight and in well-drained soil. Water frequently when in full growth, less at other times. Propagate by division of rhizomes in spring.

A. attenuata. Evergreen, rhizomatous perennial. H 36in (1m), S 20in (50cm) or more. Has long-stalked, pointed, elliptic, yellow-spotted, glossy, deep green leaves, 18–20in (45–50cm) long. Small, urn-shaped red and yellow flowers are produced at ground level in spring or fall. Z10–13

A. daibuensis. Evergreen, rhizomatous perennial. H 36in (1m), S 20in (50cm) or more. Produces lance-shaped, yellow-spotted, glossy, deep green leaves, 16–24in (40–60cm) long. Cup-shaped, yellow flowers are borne near ground level, in summer–fall. Z10–13

A. elatior (Cast-iron plant). Evergreen, rhizomatous perennial. H and S to 2ft

(60cm). Has upright, narrow, pointed-ovate leaves, to 2ft (60cm) long; inconspicuous, cream to purple flowers are occasionally produced on short stalks near soil level. Z7–11. **‘Asahi’** has variegated leaves, each with a narrow, inverted wedge-shaped, white zone extending down the leaf from the apex. **‘Variegata’** illus. p.277.

A. zongbayi ‘Uan Fat Lady’.

Evergreen, rhizomatous perennial. H and S 12in (30cm). Slender leaf stalks bear broadly ovate, wavy-margined, bright green leaves, 8in (20cm) long, speckled with greenish-yellow and with a central, broad, pale stripe. Cup-shaped, purple flowers are produced near ground level from late summer to fall. Z11–14

ASPLENIUM

ASPLENIACEAE

Genus of evergreen or semievergreen ferns. Plants described prefer partial shade, but *A. trichomanes* tolerates full sun. Grow in any moist soil; containerized plants should be grown in potting mix that includes chopped sphagnum moss or peat substitute. Regularly remove any fronds that are fading. Propagate by spores or bulbils, if produced, in late summer.

A. bulbiferum (Hen-and-chicken fern, Mother spleenwort). Tufted, semievergreen or evergreen fern. H to 28in (70cm), S 2ft (60cm). Lance-shaped, finely divided, dark green fronds produce bulbils from which young plants develop. Z9–11 **A. bulbiferum** of gardens. See *A. x lucrosum*.

A. ceterach, syn. *Ceterach officinarum* (Rusty-back fern), illus. p.293.

A. x lucrosum, syn. *A. bulbiferum* of gardens, illus. p. 478.

A. nidus (Bird’s-nest fern) illus. p.479.

A. scolopendrium, syn. *Phyllitis scolopendrium*, *Scolopendrium vulgare*, (Hart’s-tongue fern), illus. p.292.

Crispum Group illus. p.292. **Cristatum Group** cultivars are terrestrial evergreen ferns. H 2ft (60cm), S 32in (80cm). Produce irregular, shuttlecock-like crowns of strap-shaped, leathery, glossy, bright green fronds, to 16in (40cm) long, heart-shaped at the bases, often with wavy margins, and crested at the tips; fronds are fertile. Z5–9 **A. trichomanes** (Maiden-hair spleenwort) illus. p.291.

ASTELIA

ASTELIACEAE

Genus of clump-forming evergreen perennials, grown mainly for their attractive, arching foliage. Prefers full sun or semishade and fertile soil that does not dry out readily. Propagate by division in spring.

A. chathamica illus. p.242.

A. nervosa. Clump-forming perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S to 6ft (2m). Produces long, sword-shaped, arching leaves, usually 2ft (60cm) long, green and silver-woolly above, bronze to white and scaly beneath, with green midribs. In summer, bears graceful, branching panicles of small, star-shaped, pale brown flowers. Z8–9